Table 12.1 Major sources of solid waste

Waste category	Source
Residential	Food wastes, plastics, paper, glass, leather, cardboard, metals, yard wastes, ashes, tires, batteries, old mattresses
Industrial	Packaging wastes, ashes, chemicals, cans, plastics, metal parts
Commercial	Thin and thick plastics, food wastes, metals, paper, glass, wood, cardboard materials
Institutional	Wood, paper, metals, cardboard materials, electronics
Construction and Demolition	Steel materials, concrete, wood, plastics, rubber, copper wires, dirt and glass
Agriculture	Agricultural wastes, spoiled food, pesticide containers
Biomedical	Syringes, bandages, used gloves, catheter, urine bags, drugs, paper, plastics, food wastes, sanitary napkins and diapers, chemicals
E-Waste	Electronic items like used TVs, transistors, tape recorders, computer cabinets, mother boards, CDs, cassettes, mouse, wires, cords, switches., chargers



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air, ground water and can seriously affect the health of humans, wildlife and our environment **(Table 12.1).**

Solid Waste management includes the activities and actions required to manage waste from its inception to its final disposal. This includes the collection, transport, treatment and disposal of waste, together with monitoring and regulation of the waste management process. It is all about how solid waste can be changed and used as a valuable resource.

Case Study: The Corporation of Chennai looks after clearance and management of solid waste in Chennai. Every day around 5400 Metric Tonnes (MT) of garbage is collected from the city. Door to door collection of garbage is done in most zones apart from sweeping, collecting, and storing the waste in the specified bins. At present garbage generated in Chennai is dumped at two sites. Proposals are there for remediation of the existing landfill or scientific closure and to have integrated waste processing facilities with waste to energy plants as one of the components at the existing Kodungaiyur and Perungudi sites.

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